An artist uses line and colour teacher and cover plan

BUILD Spring 1 Week 3 Monday 18 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Find out about an artist who expresses feelings.

Today: I can find out how an artist uses line and colour.

Success criteria

I can name the artist or point to his name.

I can find two facts in the short description.

I can try my own idea with shapes.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For four pupils: four books or arts logs, four pencils and eight small test sheets.

Paper route: twelve ready-torn scrap shapes plus spare scrap paper, four mats and two glue sticks. Keep shapes loose until a layout is chosen. No cutting tool is required.

Drawing route: four sets of familiar drawing tools. Optional paint uses five brushes, four mats, two stable water pots, a small shared amount of washable paint and cloths.

Adult model: three original torn shapes and two different arrangements. Label them as original class examples. Do not display or copy an actual artist's work.

Quiet sound route: fingertips only, below talking volume. Materials-free route: silent hand positions or pupil-directed adult movement. Keep four labelled storage spaces for actual trials.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Read the artist name and two short facts. Say: He cut painted paper and moved the shapes.

15 to 30 seconds: Place three own torn shapes close together. Say: These are our new class shapes, not a copy of his work.

30 to 45 seconds: Move the same shapes apart. Say: I changed the spacing. This layout feels calm to me. That is my reading.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to the two tests. Say: I keep the artist fact, my own test and my reason as separate parts of my log.

Arrival and starter

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Today we find out about one real artist. You can point, speak, sign or pass. Our own art can use a made-up feeling.

What to say: An artist makes art. Today the artist is Henri Matisse. Say the name slowly, or point to it while I read it. We will use a short description, not a copy of his artwork. You may use an invented feeling for your own response and share privately.

What good looks like: The pupil can indicate the artist's name or recognise it when read aloud. No personal disclosure or public performance is required.

Materials free fallback: Read the name aloud and let the pupil confirm it with an agreed gesture. No print, image or art materials are needed.

Check and response: Naming, pointing to or confirming the spoken name is acceptable. A pupil does not need to spell the name from memory.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Watch a curved air line, then a sharp air line. What do you notice? Could each line suggest a feeling? You may have your own view.

What to say: I make a slow curve in the air, then a sharp zigzag. Tell me one thing you notice before guessing a feeling. A curve might suggest calm to me. You might read it differently. We do not know a maker's private mood from one line.

What good looks like: The pupil notices a visible feature and distinguishes it from an interpretation, with support if needed.

Materials free fallback: Describe the two lines aloud or follow the pupil's directions. A pupil can watch without making a movement.

Check and response: The curve bends smoothly; the zigzag changes direction sharply. A feeling linked to either feature is a possible reading, not a fixed rule.

Modelling and cover guidance

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I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Listen to the short artist description. Find two facts: cut shapes and moved shapes. Watch the adult try two new layouts. These class tests are our own work.

What to say: Read the artist card aloud in short parts. Matisse used line and colour to express feelings. In his cut-paper work he cut painted paper and could change the layout. Those are facts from the description. I now use my own three torn shapes. I place them close, then move them apart. I think the wider space feels calm. That last idea is my reading. These shapes and this design are an original class example, not a copy of his art.

What good looks like: The adult identifies two accurate details and models the difference between a fact and a personal interpretation. The original class sample uses a general method while retaining its own design.

Materials free fallback: Read the description aloud. Use three finger positions close together, then apart, or describe those positions. A pupil may direct the adult's hand positions.

Check and response: Ask: 'Which is a fact from the card: he moved cut shapes, or everyone must feel calm?' Expected: he moved cut shapes. If unclear, reread that sentence and point to the original class shapes.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Read the task and make two tiny tests in paint, sound or silent hand movement. Let pupils choose a feature and make a short response. Use the same timings and log prompts. No specialist demonstration is needed. If prior work is missing, use a fresh trial with today's date.

Guided practice and task

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Help place three class shapes. Try them close, then far apart. Say what changed. Choose a layout for a made-up feeling. Finish: This suggests ___ to me.

What to say: You direct our own class sample. We keep the shapes the same and change their spacing. What do you notice? Which layout could fit your invented feeling? Hinge: A pupil says all blue shapes must mean sad. Do we A accept one fixed meaning, or B ask the maker for their meaning and reason?

What good looks like: The pupil compares two layouts and gives or confirms a reason linked to spacing. The pupil recognises that a colour does not have one compulsory emotional meaning.

Materials free fallback: Direct three adult finger positions or listen to two spoken layouts. Choose verbally or with an agreed gesture.

Check and response: B. Ask the maker. If a pupil selects A, model two different readings of the same blue shape. Parallel check: 'Could a blue shape show joy to its maker?' Expected: yes, if that is their intended meaning. Move on when the pupil can identify a feature and allow another reading.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: In your book or arts log, name the artist. Keep two facts from the description. Make or draw three shapes of your own. Try two layouts. Choose one for a made-up feeling. Keep your tests and your own reason.

What to say: Choose drawing, torn paper or a silent route. For torn paper, make three simple shapes from scrap. Tearing is enough; no cutting tool is needed. Try the shapes close together and farther apart before fixing anything. For drawing, make two tiny versions on scrap. For a sound response, try three quiet taps close in time, then with wider pauses; this changes space in time in your own art form. Keep sound below talking volume and stop on my raised hand. The pupil decides the feeling and layout. Do not recreate an existing artwork. An adult may handle materials under the pupil's direction.

What good looks like: The pupil retains two real artist details, makes two original trials and chooses a layout or sequence with a reason. A simple test is enough today. Staff distinguish the artist facts, the pupil's view and the adult's observation.

Materials free fallback: Use or direct three silent hand positions close, then apart. The pupil names or confirms the artist and two spoken facts. The adult records the actual sequence and confirmed pupil reason when a recording method is available.

Check and response: Example only: Matisse cut painted paper and moved shapes. I tried three own shapes close and apart. I chose apart because it feels calm to me. This is the pupil's possible method link, not a claim about the artist's mood.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Tell an adult one fact about the artist. Show your two tests and chosen layout. Say: I chose ___ because ___. Tidy and keep your work for next time.

What to say: Ask for an artist fact first, then the pupil's own view. A listener describes one feature before offering a different interpretation. The maker can keep their choice. Sharing may be private. Use the last two minutes to cap glue, collect scraps and store loose shapes and tests flat in each pupil's own tray.

What good looks like: The pupil separates an accurate artist detail from a personal interpretation. The trials and chosen layout are retained honestly for lesson two.

Materials free fallback: The pupil directs a repeat of their silent layout. The adult repeats one fact and asks the pupil to confirm or correct it, then records the pupil's own choice.

Check and response: A useful artist fact is that he moved cut shapes to test a layout. A personal view is that a pupil's wide gaps seem calm. Both belong in the log with their different purposes clear.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: The artist is ___. Two facts I found are ___ and ___. My own test used ___. I chose ___ because ___.

What to say: Keep the actual artist facts and your own work separate in the log. I can scribe your words, read them back and let you correct them. Use today's real date and record the help used. Keep your own tests so you can make a short response next time.

What good looks like: A dated entry gives or confirms the artist's name, two facts, a pupil-made trial and a chosen feature with a reason. No adult example is prefilled as pupil evidence.

Materials free fallback: Use an oral log. The adult confirms the name, facts and choice with the pupil, then makes a dated witness note at the next recording opportunity.

Check and response: Example only: The artist is Henri Matisse. He cut painted paper and moved shapes. I tried three own shapes apart. I chose wide gaps because they feel calm to me.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

An artist's work tells us exactly how they felt - A description can give facts about a method. A feeling suggested to a viewer is an interpretation, not proof of a private mood.

To learn from an artist we must copy their picture - Use a general method, such as moving shapes, then make an original design with the pupil's own shapes and arrangement.

A colour always means one feeling - Ask the maker for their intended meaning and a reason. Different personal and cultural readings are valid.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.